HARVARD MEDICAL SCHOOL | Master of Science in Clinical Research

SMCR Capstone Progress Report 3: Evidence Synthesis and Full-Draft Readiness

***Meeting deadline**:* Friday, January 15, 2027

Next milestone: First Full Draft Submission - Monday, February 8, 2027

Purpose: To confirm that the literature search, study selection, data extraction, risk-of-bias assessment, and evidence synthesis are sufficiently complete and methodologically sound for the student to submit a complete capstone manuscript by February 8.

Instructions: The student should complete Sections A-C and submit this report to the advisor at least 24 hours before the meeting. The advisor should complete Section D following the meeting.

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A. Student and Project Information

Student:

Program Advisor:

Date of Meeting:

Working Capstone Title:

_____
_____
_____

Proposed Research Question(s):

_____
_____
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B. Review Progress Checklist

Indicate the status of each component.

Review Component	Complete	In Progress	Not Started	Not Applicable
Final search strategies documented	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Searches completed across all databases	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Search results exported and archived	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Duplicate records removed	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Title and abstract screening completed	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Full-text screening completed	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Reasons for full-text exclusion documented	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Screening disagreements resolved	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
PRISMA flow counts reconciled	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Data extraction completed	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Extracted data independently verified	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]

Missing or unclear data addressed	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Risk-of-bias assessment completed	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Risk-of-bias disagreements resolved	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Study characteristics table drafted	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Primary evidence synthesis completed	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Meta-analysis completed, if applicable	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Subgroup or sensitivity analyses completed	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Results tables and figures drafted	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Results section drafted	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Discussion section drafted	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
References updated and checked	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]

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C. Student Pre-Meeting Progress Report

1. Manuscript drafting status

Manuscript Component	Complete	In Progress	Not Started
Title and abstract	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Introduction	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Methods	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Results	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Discussion	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Conclusions	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
References	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Tables and figures	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]
Supplementary materials	[ ]	[ ]	[ ]

2. Were any methods changed after the protocol was finalized? [ ] No [ ] Yes

If yes, describe each change, provide the reason, and explain how it will be reported in the manuscript:

_____

_____

3. Current barriers or concerns

Identify any issue that could prevent submission of a complete manuscript by February 8.

[ ] Screening is incomplete
[ ] Data extraction is incomplete
[ ] Risk-of-bias assessment is incomplete
[ ] Screening or extraction disagreements remain unresolved
[ ] Statistical analysis is incomplete
[ ] Statistical support is needed
[ ] Results tables or figures are incomplete
[ ] Manuscript writing is behind schedule
[ ] Additional advisor decisions are needed
[ ] Other: _____

Explanation:

_____

_____

3. Guidance needed from the advisor

List the specific methodological or scientific decisions that must be resolved during this meeting.

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D. Advisor Assessment and Scoring

Score each criterion using the following scale:

- **4: Fully meets expectations:** Complete, rigorous, and ready to proceed.
- **3: Mostly meets expectations:** Adequate; minor revisions are needed.
- **2: Developing:** Partially complete; substantive revisions are needed.
- **1: Limited progress:** Major deficiencies require immediate attention.
- **0: No evidence:** Not submitted or not addressed.

Assessment Criterion	Advisor Score	Advisor Comments
Literature search, study screening, and study selection have been completed, with the final included studies appropriately documented.	___ / 4	
Data extraction has been completed, and extracted data are accurate, complete, and organized for analysis.	___ / 4	
Risk-of-bias assessment has been completed using an appropriate appraisal tool and applied consistently across included studies.	___ / 4	
Evidence synthesis (and meta-analysis, where applicable) has been completed, and the results are appropriately summarized and interpreted.	___ / 4	
Methods & Results are sufficiently developed and on track for submission of the First Manuscript Draft by February 8, 2027.	___ / 4	
Total Score	**___ / 20**	

Advisor's Overall Progress Determination

[ ] **Green – On track:** The project is appropriately scoped, and the student is prepared for the next milestone.
[ ] **Yellow – Support required:** Correctable deficiencies remain. Specific actions and a follow-up date are required.
[ ] **Red – At risk:** The question is not yet feasible or sufficiently developed. A formal remediation plan and program notification are required.

Overall advisor comments:

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